

Slopes and local change

Project: Image-pattern Network Investigation

1. Recall and choose your starting point

Try the recall before opening notes. Then use a different colour or a labelled second line to correct your explanation.

Loss functions

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Loss functions. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

My remembered idea, example and correction

Forward passes by hand

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Forward passes by hand. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

My remembered idea, example and correction

Bias terms and decision boundaries

Without opening the old lesson, explain one key idea from Bias terms and decision boundaries. Give an example and a mistake that the idea helps you avoid.

My remembered idea, example and correction

2. Practise with fading help

Use W2: Check a symmetric estimate for Slopes and local change. Record the answer once; the lesson and workbook refer to the same attempt.

Given inputs · Procedure I chose · Middle steps · Result and check

Given inputs: _____

Procedure I chose: _____

Middle steps: _____

Result and check: _____

The step I completed without help, and the hint I needed

3. Individual reasoning check

Use the worked case for Slopes and local change. Proposed explanation: “Divide by the step only”. Decide whether this explanation is supported. Point to the step or supplied fact that decides; explain your repair if needed.

My explanation before partner discussion

4. Independent transfer case

Independent case: Estimate a new curve independently

Let $J(a) = (a + 1)^2$. At $a = 1$ use step 0.25 to find the symmetric slope. Compare $J(1)$ with $J(0.9)$, then explain why moving to -4 does not follow safely from the slope clue.

My independent explanation, trace and limits

Attempt this case before feedback. Record any help. Earlier examples below are further practice; a case already practised with feedback cannot establish fresh transfer.

5. W1 Measure an interval slope

For $L(w) = (w - 2)^2$, calculate the average slope from $w = 0$ to $w = 2$. Compare it with the local slope at $w = 2$.

My reasoning and evidence

6. W2 Check a symmetric estimate

At centre $w = 0$, use step 0.5. Calculate $L(-0.5)$, $L(0.5)$ and the symmetric slope.

My reasoning and evidence

7. W3 Challenge a large step

Starting at $w = 3$, compare loss after moving to 2.9 and after moving to -1. Both moves decrease w .

My reasoning and evidence

8. W4 Estimate a new curve independently

Let $J(a) = (a + 1)$ squared. At $a = 1$ use step 0.25 to find the symmetric slope. Compare $J(1)$ with $J(0.9)$, then explain why moving to -4 does not follow safely from the slope clue.

My reasoning and evidence

9. W5 Limit zero slope evidence

For $F(w) = (w^2 - 1)^2$, compare $F(0)$ and $F(0.1)$. Does zero local slope at zero prove a minimum?

My reasoning and evidence

10. Project checkpoint and reflection

Add a labelled slopes and local change evidence sheet to Image-pattern Network Investigation. Show how you can calculate an average rate of change over a stated interval. Use the supplied fictional case and keep its inputs, intermediate steps, calculation or prediction, and limitation. Connect this record to last week's record; a matching answer without a trace is insufficient.

My project change, supporting evidence and remaining limit

11. Feedback, return check and learning record

Evidence · My record

Evidence: Worked alone / hint / model

My record: _____

Evidence: First step I repaired and why

My record: _____

Evidence: New case checked later; date and result

My record: _____

Evidence: What I can now explain without notes

My record: _____

Evidence: One remaining question

My record: _____

Revisit this idea with your teacher after a delay. Familiarity is different from explaining and using it on a changed case.

12. Pictorial case practice: Slopes and local change

Use a local slope to propose a small move rather than claiming every move helps.

Toy loss $J(a)=(a-2)^2$. At $a = 0$, use symmetric step 0.5.

All inputs and outcomes in this worked example are invented classroom data; no real model run is claimed.

Slopes and local change

Start with the supplied facts

Follow each arrow. Ask which fact allows the next step.



1. Evaluate nearby points

$J(0.5)=2.25$ and $J(-0.5)=6.25$.



2. Estimate slope

$\text{Slope} = (2.25 - 6.25) / (0.5 - (-0.5)) = -4$.



3. Check small move

Move to $a = 0.25$: loss 3.0625, below starting loss 4.

CHANGE ONE THING

Move from 0 all the way to 5.

Explain the changed result using the matching lesson.

Which calculation disproves “any increase helps”? Point to the relevant step in the picture, then write the changed result and the rule or evidence that supports it.

My picture-based explanation and changed-case prediction

Support used: alone / hint / worked example. This record is practice evidence.

Project connection: For your Image-pattern Network Investigation, save the input, procedure, observed result and limitation of this check. Label this worked example as practice; use a different, previously unreviewed case when checking independent understanding.